

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Can We Help Wild Bees?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	In ancient times, honey was known as _____.
2	A listener says there is a _____ around whether eating honey helps bees.
3	Around the world, there are _____ of bee.
4	Honey bees are widespread and are _____.
5	In the UK, there are _____ of bumblebee.
6	Of these, _____ have gone extinct.
7	Some remaining bumblebee species survive in _____ of good habitat.
8	We rely on insects to _____ and keep ecosystems working.
9	_____ of plant species need insects for pollination.
10	One suggested action is growing bee-friendly plants such as _____.

What is the main question explored in the discussion?

- A Whether eating honey is the best way to protect honey bees.
- B Whether honey bees are more valuable than other insect species.
- C Whether eating honey can help declining wild bee populations.
- D Whether vegan diets are responsible for lower bee numbers.

What does Saoirse feel uncertain about?

- A Whether honey has medicinal value.
- B Whether eating honey might help save bees.
- C Whether vegans should eat any animal products.
- D Whether bee populations are actually declining.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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What attitude is shown towards honey bees compared with wild bees?

- A Honey bees are treated as the species in immediate danger.
- B Honey bees are presented as less threatened than many wild bees.
- C Honey bees are described as harmful to the survival of bumblebees.
- D Honey bees are dismissed as unimportant because they are managed.

Why are many wild bees struggling more than honey bees?

- A They produce less honey and are therefore less useful to humans.
- B They have fewer beekeepers and less direct human protection.
- C They cannot pollinate crops as effectively as honey bees.
- D They survive only in cities rather than natural habitats.

What contrast is made between honey bees and wild bees?

- A Honey bees are widespread and cared for; wild bees may be isolated and overlooked.
- B Honey bees are extinct in the UK; wild bees are increasing in number.
- C Honey bees live only in farms; wild bees live only in forests.
- D Honey bees pollinate plants; wild bees mainly recycle waste.

What opinion does Dave Goulson express about insects' work?

- A Their best-known role is less useful than people believe.
- B Their hidden jobs are important but often unnoticed.
- C Their contribution matters only when crops are failing.
- D Their value is mostly limited to making food taste better.

In "that isn't the only thing", what does "that" refer to?

- A Making honey for humans.
- B Looking after wild bees.
- C Pollination by insects.
- D Decline in bee populations.

What can be inferred about eating more honey?

- A It may help beekeepers but is unlikely to solve wild bee decline.
- B It is the most practical action for people who cannot grow plants.
- C It will protect all bee species if enough people take part.
- D It is harmful because honey bees are already widespread.

Why are examples like recycling cow poo and keeping soil healthy mentioned?

- A To make bee behaviour sound more glamorous to listeners.
- B To show that insects support ecosystems in less obvious ways.
- C To explain why honey bees are not endangered at all.
- D To prove that pollination is no longer bees' main job.

What is the overall implication of the discussion?

- A Protecting bees requires focusing beyond honey bees and recognising wider ecosystem roles.
- B Eating honey is the simplest way for consumers to reverse insect decline.
- C Wild bees are declining mainly because people do not understand vegan diets.
- D Honey production should stop so that wild bees can recover naturally.